

1 Introduction to this manual and overview of the export procedure

1.1 Purpose

The purpose of this manual is to update and revise the existing material relating to customs export procedures. It is intended for the use of Revenue officials dealing with all aspects relating to the exportation of goods.

The movement of goods from Ireland to another Member State of the EU is often referred to as an “export”. However, under Single Market rules such movements are treated as intra-Union supplies and the presentation of customs export declarations in relation to such movements is not required. The one exception is where goods are moving to a part of the Union which is not part of the fiscal territory of the Union e.g. The Canary Islands. It should be noted that some prohibitions or restrictions on exports do apply to movements from Ireland to other Member States (see [Section 11](#)).

At present there are 27 Member States of the EU as follows: Austria, Belgium, Bulgaria, Croatia, Cyprus, Czech Republic, Denmark, Estonia, Finland, France, Germany, Greece, Hungary, Ireland, Italy, Latvia, Lithuania, Luxembourg, Malta, Netherlands, Poland, Portugal, Romania, Slovakia, Slovenia, Spain, and Sweden.

1.1.1 Brexit

The United Kingdom (UK) held a Brexit referendum on 23 June 2016. They subsequently invoked Article 50 of the Treaty on European Union.

As a result of those actions the UK has left the European Union (EU) and is now a non-EU country.

In January 2020, the European Parliament and the UK Parliament ratified the Withdrawal Agreement and the UK officially left at 11pm (GMT) on 31 January. The UK entered a transition period from 1 February until 31 December 2020. During this period the UK was treated, for the purposes of the movement of goods, services, and people, as if it were a full EU Member State.

Provisions relating to Northern Ireland are covered by the revised Protocol to the Withdrawal Agreement effective from 1 January 2021. The effect of the Northern Ireland Protocol allows for goods originating in Northern Ireland to be treated as Union goods when trading with the EU and vice versa. This agreement has been further enhanced by the [Windsor Framework](#), effective from 25 March 2023, which will include customs simplifications, facilitations for parcel post and the expansion of the trusted trader scheme.

Further details on the topic of Brexit can be found on the [Revenue website](#).